

Frank Nowicki

Linux Systems Engineer · Enterprise Migration & Client-Facing Technical Consulting

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SUMMARY

Linux systems engineer with 20+ years administering enterprise Linux and Unix estates for automotive, financial-services, and BPO clients — including six years client-facing in pre-sales and post-sales engineering: requirements analysis, technical presentations, proofs of concept, customer enablement, and executive-level briefings. Strong problem determination background, habitually the escalation point for issues nobody else could reproduce — root-cause work that took one enterprise estate from roughly 300 monthly incidents to 80. Repeated record of planned migrations delivered with **zero data loss**: 600+ users to a new secure file-transfer platform, multiple file systems onto scale-out enterprise storage, and a full backup-platform migration across mixed Unix and Windows clients. Production RHEL, SUSE, Ubuntu, CentOS, and Solaris 8–11, with enterprise storage, Fibre Channel-attached SAN environments, and Cisco networking. AWS Certified Solutions Architect and SysOps Administrator. Currently building IBM Z / LinuxONE and OpenShift depth — see below.

CORE SKILLS

Linux Distributions	Red Hat Enterprise Linux, SUSE, Ubuntu, CentOS; Solaris 8–11 — 5+ years running these distributions in production enterprise environments
Linux Administration	Installation and automated provisioning (JumpStart imaging, standardized golden builds), patching and lifecycle management, kernel tuning, systemd services, LVM and filesystem management, SELinux policy, firewall configuration, performance tuning and capacity analysis
Migration & Consolidation	Dependency and readiness assessment, cutover sequencing around production windows, rollback planning, change control; user, filesystem, storage-platform, and backup-platform migrations completed without data loss
Client-Facing Consulting	Requirements analysis, technical presentations and product demonstrations, proofs of concept, solution scoping with sales teams, customer training and enablement, runbook and build documentation, release coordination across test leads, project managers, and supplier resources; structured post-implementation feedback routed back to product engineering
Problem Determination	Systems-level analysis of non-routine performance, stability, and security issues; Level 2/3 escalation ownership; root-cause investigation and permanent remediation rather than recurring workarounds
Storage & SAN	EMC Isilon scale-out NAS, EMC Celerra, NetApp, Snap Appliance NAS; volume provisioning, mirroring (Solstice DiskSuite), and rsync-based replication in Fibre Channel-attached array environments; NetBackup and NetVault backup platform administration and migration; NFS
Networking	Cisco routing and switching (OSPF, EIGRP, STP, EtherChannel), CCENT certified; DNS, NFS, FTP/SFTP; firewall configuration and service hardening; load balancing and high-availability patterns
Containers & Cloud	Docker, Kubernetes, OpenStack; AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, IAM, Backup) — Solutions Architect and SysOps Administrator certified; Cloudflare Workers, KV, and Pages; Azure
Automation & Scripting	Bash, Python (Django, Flask, Pandas, asyncio), Perl, PowerShell, C/C++, SQL; Ansible, Puppet, Chef, Jenkins; provisioning automation, monitoring and alerting tooling, CI/CD pipelines; Oracle 12c (Certified DBA) and PostgreSQL administration

EXPERIENCE

Independent Cloud & Platform Engineer — Self-Employed

2024 – Present · Remote

- Designed and operate a production serverless platform on a global edge network — authenticated endpoints, scheduled sweep jobs, and distributed key-value state — including a server-side dead-man's-switch that delivers alerts when the user's device is powered off, verified end to end in unattended production testing.
- Diagnosed a silent multi-day production outage from user-visible symptoms alone, tracing a degraded fallback path back to a credential removed from configuration and never re-provisioned as a secret; built a zero-cost authentication probe so the same failure class is detected in seconds rather than days.
- Root-caused a two-week message-delivery failure that had been attributed to an external vendor approval process, proving the real cause was a message-template validation rule — a reminder that the accepted explanation is not always the correct one.

Career Break — Family Caregiving & Professional Development

2017 – 2023

- Full-time caregiver for a family member while maintaining and deepening technical skills through structured certification study.
- Earned **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** and **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018), and **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA).
- Completed Red Hat Enterprise Linux administration and security training — SELinux policy, firewall configuration, service hardening, monitoring, and performance tuning — alongside Docker, Kubernetes, Puppet, and Python automation coursework.

Senior Unix/Linux System Administrator — SourceHOV

Oct 2011 – Jan 2017 · Troy, MI

- Senior technical escalation point for Linux and Unix issues across a neglected, failure-prone enterprise estate; assessed it end to end, established configuration and operational standards, and rebuilt it into a stable, monitored, predictable platform.
- Reduced monthly incident volume from roughly 300 tickets to 80 through root-cause analysis, proactive remediation, and reprioritization of recurring failure classes — fixing causes rather than reissuing workarounds.
- Planned and led a migration of 600+ users to a new secure file-transfer platform and relocated multiple file systems onto EMC Isilon scale-out storage — assessed dependencies and rollback risk up front, coordinated cutover windows with business owners, and completed both with **zero data loss**.
- Designed and implemented monitoring and alerting for mail, web, and file-transfer services, introducing process-threshold management where none existed and surfacing degradation before it reached users.
- Automated user-account provisioning, cutting a manual two-hour process to twenty minutes and removing a standing source of configuration drift.

Unix System Administrator — TEKsystems (Contract)

May 2007 – Jan 2008 · Warren, MI

- Built and maintained a production-parity test environment covering patch levels, security configuration, telecom access, and kernel tuning, so changes were validated against real production behavior before release.
- Established prioritization and governance for customer resource requests, and coordinated releases across test leads, project managers, and supplier resources.

Unix System Administrator — Incentra Solutions / DaimlerChrysler (SHAP)

Apr 2005 – Nov 2006 · Sterling Heights, MI

- Deployed and configured network-attached storage appliances backing up plant servers across all Chrysler facilities — on-site hardware and system build-out, then ongoing administration of Linux-based GuardianOS, DNS, and NFS.
- Led migration of Unix and Windows clients from NetBackup to NetVault across Solaris 2.6–9 environments, evaluating per-client dependencies, submitting change controls, and sequencing cutovers around plant production windows.
- Troubleshot backend network, server, client, and software issues across a multi-site manufacturing estate; coordinated installation schedules with client IS teams.

Unix System Administrator — LaSalle Bank (Contract)

Jun 2004 – Jan 2005 · Troy, MI

- Automated EMC Celerra volume creation and rsync-based replication in Bash; built mirrored volumes with Solstice DiskSuite and standardized Solaris 8 post-installation through JumpStart imaging for repeatable, auditable builds in a regulated financial-services environment.

Systems Engineer — Pre-Sales & Post-Sales — Technical Solutions, LLC

Jun 1997 – Jun 2003 · Troy, MI

- Six years in a client-facing technical role: partnered with sales to scope opportunities, gather and analyze customer requirements, and deliver technical presentations, product demonstrations, and proofs of concept to prospective clients and their decision-makers.
- Implemented solutions in client IT environments post-sale — integration, configuration, and handover — then trained customer staff on operational best practices to drive successful adoption.
- Owned Level 2/3 escalation for the installed base, resolving issues directly with client staff through the full engagement lifecycle; gathered structured post-implementation feedback and routed it back to product engineering to shape subsequent releases.

CURRENT DEVELOPMENT

- **IBM Z / LinuxONE:** building hands-on depth through IBM Z Xplore and the LinuxONE Community Cloud — Linux under z/VM, LPAR concepts, and s390x tooling. New ground for me, and stated plainly: the Linux, storage, migration, and client-facing layers are enterprise-deep; the platform layer is what I am actively closing.
- **Red Hat OpenShift:** Red Hat Developer Sandbox and OpenShift Local (CRC), building on existing Docker and Kubernetes experience, targeting DO280 / EX280.

WHAT COLLEAGUES SAY

"Frank was the senior Unix admin when I worked with him at SourceHOV. He expertly fixed a neglected Unix environment, proactively configured systems so they no longer failed, and added value by putting monitoring in place and setting standards. Under his leadership it became a stable, predictable platform. He is one of the very best Unix admins I have worked with and would be a benefit to any company that hires him."

— Steve Allison, Backup and Recovery Engineer · worked with Frank at SourceHOV

"Frank is an awesome System Administrator. Professional. Effective. Solution-oriented. Looking forward to working with Frank again soon."

— Kuldip Bhatt, Senior Technology & CRM Operations Leader

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate** (2018) · **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate** (2018) · **Cisco CCENT**
- **Oracle Database 12c Administrator Certified Professional** (2019–2020, 4.0 GPA)
- **Associate of Applied Science, Information Technology** — Macomb Community College · **Unix/C Certificate Program** — Marygrove College